DEPLOYMENT HANDBOOK

VIRTUAL CONTROL

VMWARE CLOUD FOUNDATION SOLUTIONS

VCF Offline Depot Handbook

Step-by-step guide to building and configuring HTTPS offline depots for air-gapped VCF deployments.

OFFLINE DEPOT | HTTPS | AIR-GAPPED | REPOSITORY

VCF 9.0 VMware Cloud Foundation

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VCF 9.0.1 Offline Depot Handbook

1. Environment Reference

Component	IP Address	FQDN	Role
Windows Depot Server	192.168.1.160	—	HTTPS offline depot (Python), port 8443
VCF Installer	192.168.1.240	vcf-installer.lab.local	Initial bring-up appliance
SDDC Manager	192.168.1.241	sddc-manager.lab.local	Post-deployment lifecycle management
vCenter Server	192.168.1.69	vcenter.lab.local	vSphere management
DNS / NTP / AD	192.168.1.230	dc.lab.local	Infrastructure services
Gateway	192.168.1.1	—	Default gateway

> ***Note:*** *The VCF Installer appliance (192.168.1.240) is used during initial bring-up. After deployment completes, SDDC Manager (192.168.1.241) takes over lifecycle management and depot operations. Both need depot access at different stages.*

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2. Prerequisites

2.1 Required Downloads from Broadcom Support Portal

Metadata (required):

- `vcf-9.0.1.0-offline-depot-metadata.zip` — Contains the PROD directory structure with manifest, product version catalog, vSAN HCL data, and compatibility data

Appliances and Binaries (VCF 9.0.1):

File	Component	Size
`VCF-SDDC-Manager-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24962180.ova`	SDDC Manager	~15 GB
`VMware-VCSA-all-9.0.1.0.24957454.iso`	vCenter Server	~8 GB
`nsx-unified-appliance-9.0.1.0.24952114.ova`	NSX Manager	~12 GB
`VCF-OPS-Lifecycle-Manager-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960371.ova`	Aria Lifecycle	~5 GB
`Operations-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960351.ova`	VCF Operations	~5 GB

`Operations-Cloud-Proxy-9.0.1.0.24960349.ova`	Operations Collector	~3 GB
`O11N_VA-9.0.1.0.24923009.ova`	Orchestrator	~3 GB
`vmsp-vcfa-combined-9.0.1.0.24965341.tar`	VCF Automation	~15 GB
`Operations-Logs-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960345.ova`	Operations for Logs	~4 GB
`Operations-Logs-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960345.pak`	Operations for Logs PAK	~1 GB
`vidb-external-9.0.1.0.24941398.tar`	Identity Broker	~2 GB
`VmwareCompatibilityData.json`	Compatibility Data	~1 MB

2.2 Software Requirements

- Windows machine with Python 3.x installed
- OpenSSL (included with Git for Windows or standalone)
- Network connectivity between the depot server and SDDC Manager / VCF Installer

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3. HTTPS Depot Server Setup (Windows)

3.1 Generate Self-Signed TLS Certificate

```
openssl req -x509 -newkey rsa:2048 `
  -keyout "C:\VCF-Depot\server.key" `
  -out "C:\VCF-Depot\server.crt" `
  -days 365 -nodes `
  -subj "/CN=192.168.1.160" `
  -addext "subjectAltName=IP:192.168.1.160" -sha256
```

Alternatively, use the Python certificate generator:

```
cd C:\VCF-Depot
python generate_cert.py
```

This creates:

- `server.crt` — the public certificate (will be imported into SDDC Manager)
- `server.key` — the private key (stays on the depot server)

3.2 HTTPS Server Options

Two server scripts are available depending on your authentication needs:

Option A: FIPS-Compliant Server (No Authentication)

Script: `C:\VCF-Depot\https_server_fips.py`

- TLS 1.2 only (required for BouncyCastle FIPS on SDDC Manager)
- FIPS-approved cipher suites (AES-GCM)
- No authentication — use when depot is on isolated lab network
- Listens on port 8443

```
cd C:\VCF-Depot
python https_server_fips.py
```

Option B: Authenticated Server (Basic Auth)

Script: `C:\VCF-Depot\https_server.py`

- TLS 1.2–1.3
- Basic authentication (default: admin/admin)
- Use when depot needs access control
- Listens on port 8443

```
cd C:\VCF-Depot
python https_server.py
```

> ***Which to use:*** *For the VCF Installer bring-up phase, use the* ***FIPS server (Option A)*** *— the installer's BouncyCastle FIPS implementation is strict about cipher suites. For post-deployment depot operations through SDDC Manager, either option works. When using Option B, enter the username/password in the depot configuration UI.*

3.3 Windows Firewall Rule

```
netsh advfirewall firewall add rule name="VCF Depot 8443" dir=in action=allow
protocol=tcp localport=8443
```

3.4 Verify the Server

Open a browser and navigate to:

```
https://192.168.1.160:8443/
```

Accept the self-signed certificate warning. You should see a directory listing.

---

4. Depot Directory Structure

4.1 Extract Metadata

Extract the official metadata zip to create the base PROD structure:

```
Expand-Archive -Path "vcf-9.0.1.0-offline-depot-metadata.zip" -DestinationPath
"C:\VCF-Depot\metadata-extract" -Force
Copy-Item "C:\VCF-Depot\metadata-extract\PROD\*" "C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\" -Recurse -
Force
```

This creates the metadata structure that SDDC Manager queries first:

```
C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\
├── metadata\
│   ├── manifest\v1\
│   │   └── vcfManifest.json
│   └── productVersionCatalog\v1\
│       ├── productVersionCatalog.json
│       └── productVersionCatalog.sig
├── vsan\hcl\
│   ├── all.json
│   └── lastupdatedtime.json
└── COMP\SDDC_MANAGER_VCF\Compatibility\
    └── VmwareCompatibilityData.json
```

4.2 Create Component Directories

```
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\COMP\SDDC_MANAGER_VCF" -
Force
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\COMP\VCENTER" -Force
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\COMP\NSX_T_MANAGER" -Force
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\COMP\VRSLCM" -Force
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\COMP\VROPS" -Force
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\COMP\VCF_OPS_CLOUD_PROXY" -
Force
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\COMP\VRA" -Force
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\COMP\VRO" -Force
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\COMP\VRLI" -Force
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Path "C:\VCF-
Depot\PROD\COMP\SDDC_MANAGER_VCF\lcm\productVersionCatalog" -Force
```

4.3 Place Binaries

Copy each binary to its respective component directory:

File	Destination Directory
`VCF-SDDC-Manager-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24962180.ova`	`PROD\COMP\SDDC_MANAGER_VCF\`
`VMware-VCSA-all-9.0.1.0.24957454.iso`	`PROD\COMP\VCENTER\`
`nsx-unified-appliance-9.0.1.0.24952114.ova`	`PROD\COMP\NSX_T_MANAGER\`
`VCF-OPS-Lifecycle-Manager-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960371.ova`	`PROD\COMP\VRSLCM\`
`Operations-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960351.ova`	`PROD\COMP\VROPS\`
`Operations-Cloud-Proxy-9.0.1.0.24960349.ova`	`PROD\COMP\VCF_OPS_CLOUD_PROXY\`
`O11N_VA-9.0.1.0.24923009.ova`	`PROD\COMP\VRO\`
`vmsp-vcfa-combined-9.0.1.0.24965341.tar`	`PROD\COMP\VRA\`
`Operations-Logs-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960345.ova`	`PROD\COMP\VRLI\`
`Operations-Logs-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960345.pak`	`PROD\COMP\VRLI\`
`vidb-external-9.0.1.0.24941398.tar`	`PROD\COMP\VIDB\`

`productVersionCatalog.json`	`PROD\COMP\SDDC_MANAGER_VCF\lcm\productVersionCatalog\`

4.4 Final Directory Structure

```
C:\VCF-Depot\
├── https_server.py             # Authenticated HTTPS server
├── https_server_fips.py        # FIPS-compliant HTTPS server
├── generate_cert.py            # Certificate generator
├── server.crt                  # TLS certificate
├── server.key                  # TLS private key
├── start_depot.bat             # Server startup script
└── PROD\
    ├── metadata\
    │   ├── manifest\v1\
    │   │   └── vcfManifest.json
    │   └── productVersionCatalog\v1\
    │       ├── productVersionCatalog.json
    │       └── productVersionCatalog.sig
    ├── vsan\hcl\
    │   ├── all.json
    │   └── lastupdatedtime.json
    └── COMP\
        ├── SDDC_MANAGER_VCF\
        │   ├── VCF-SDDC-Manager-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24962180.ova
        │   ├── Compatibility\
        │   │   └── VmwareCompatibilityData.json
        │   └── lcm\productVersionCatalog\
        │       └── productVersionCatalog.json
        ├── VCENTER\
        │   └── VMware-VCSA-all-9.0.1.0.24957454.iso
        ├── NSX_T_MANAGER\
        │   └── nsx-unified-appliance-9.0.1.0.24952114.ova
        ├── VRSLCM\
        │   └── VCF-OPS-Lifecycle-Manager-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960371.ova
        ├── VROPS\
        │   └── Operations-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960351.ova
        ├── VCF_OPS_CLOUD_PROXY\
        │   └── Operations-Cloud-Proxy-9.0.1.0.24960349.ova
```

```
        ├── VRA\
        │   └── vmsp-vcfa-combined-9.0.1.0.24965341.tar
        ├── VRLI\
        │   ├── Operations-Logs-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960345.ova
        │   └── Operations-Logs-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960345.pak
        ├── VIDB\
        │   └── vidb-external-9.0.1.0.24941398.tar
        └── VRO\
            └── O11N_VA-9.0.1.0.24923009.ova
```

---

5. SDDC Manager / VCF Installer Preparation

Before configuring the depot, two prerequisites must be completed on the appliance.

5.1 Fix Hostname Resolution

The appliance must resolve its own hostname and vCenter's hostname. Without self-resolution, the LCM service fails with `java.net.UnknownHostException`.

```
# SSH into the appliance
ssh vcf@192.168.1.240    # VCF Installer during bring-up
# or
ssh vcf@192.168.1.241    # SDDC Manager post-deployment
su -

# Verify hostname resolves
hostname -f

# If it returns "Unknown host", add entries to /etc/hosts:
echo "192.168.1.240 vcf-installer.lab.local vcf-installer" >> /etc/hosts
echo "192.168.1.69 vcenter.lab.local vcenter" >> /etc/hosts

# Verify
hostname -f
python3 -c "import socket; print(socket.getaddrinfo('vcenter.lab.local', 443))"
```

5.2 Import Depot Certificate into Trust Stores

The self-signed certificate from the depot server must be imported into the Java trust store before the depot can be configured.

Step 1: Extract the certificate from the running depot server:

```
echo | openssl s_client -connect 192.168.1.160:8443 2>/dev/null | openssl x509 >
/tmp/depot.crt
cat /tmp/depot.crt    # Verify it shows a PEM certificate
```

Step 2: Find and import into Java cacerts:

```
CACERTS=$(find /usr -name cacerts 2>/dev/null | head -1)
echo "Truststore: $CACERTS"

keytool -importcert -trustcacerts -alias offline-depot \
  -file /tmp/depot.crt \
  -keystore $CACERTS \
  -storepass "changeit" -noprompt
```

Step 3: Import into commonsvcs trust store (if it exists):

```
COMMONSVCS="/etc/vmware/vcf/commonsvcs/temp_java_trusted_certificates.store"
if [ -f "$COMMONSVCS" ]; then
  keytool -importcert -trustcacerts -alias offline-depot \
    -file /tmp/depot.crt \
    -keystore $COMMONSVCS \
    -storepass "changeit" -noprompt
fi
```

Step 4: Restart services and verify:

```
systemctl restart commonsvcs lcm
# Wait 2-3 minutes
```

```
systemctl status commonsvcs lcm
```

Both services should show `active (running)`.

Step 5: Verify import:

```
keytool -list -keystore $CACERTS -storepass changeit | grep offline-depot
```

---

6. Configure Offline Depot in SDDC Manager UI

6.1 Access the UI

Open a browser and navigate to:

```
https://192.168.1.240/    # VCF Installer during bring-up
# or
https://192.168.1.241/    # SDDC Manager post-deployment
```

6.2 Configure Depot Connection

In the depot configuration screen, enter:

Field	Value (FIPS Server)	Value (Auth Server)
FQDN or IP Address	`192.168.1.160`	`192.168.1.160`
Port	`8443`	`8443`
Repository Path	`/PROD`	`/PROD`
Username	*(leave empty)*	`admin`
Password	*(leave empty)*	`admin`

Click **Configure**. SDDC Manager validates connectivity with a HEAD request to:

```
/PROD/metadata/productVersionCatalog/v1/productVersionCatalog.json
```

On success, the available VCF versions (e.g., 9.0.0.0, 9.0.1.0) appear in the UI.

6.3 Download Binaries

Select **VCF 9.0.1.0** and initiate the binary download. Monitor the depot server console window for request activity. All requests should return `200` status codes.

SDDC Manager downloads binaries to:

```
/nfs/vmware/vcf/nfs-mount/bundle/
```

---

7. Troubleshooting

7.1 "Secure protocol communication error" / 502 on /v1/system/settings/depot

Cause: SDDC Manager cannot validate the TLS connection to the depot server. The self-signed certificate is not in the trust store, or internal services are not running.

Fix:

1. Verify the certificate is imported into both trust stores (Section 5.2)
2. Verify `/etc/hosts` is configured correctly (Section 5.1)
3. Restart services: `systemctl restart commonsvcs lcm`
4. Check service status: `systemctl status commonsvcs lcm`

7.2 "Path not found" / 404 File Not Found

Cause: The requested file does not exist at the expected path in the depot.

Fix: Check the HTTPS server console logs on the Windows machine. The log shows the exact path requested:

```
192.168.1.241 - "HEAD /PROD/COMP/VCENTER/VMware-VCSA-all-9.0.1.0.24957454.iso
HTTP/1.1" 404 -
```

This tells you:

- **Component directory:** `VCENTER`
- **Required file:** `VMware-VCSA-all-9.0.1.0.24957454.iso`
- **Action:** Place the file at `C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\COMP\VCENTER\VMware-VCSA-all-9.0.1.0.24957454.iso`

Reference: [Broadcom KB 413848]

7.3 "Product Version Catalog (PVC) does not exist"

Cause: The `productVersionCatalog.json` was not extracted from the official metadata zip, or the LCM-specific copy is missing.

Fix:

1. Extract metadata from the official zip file (Section 4.1)
2. Copy `productVersionCatalog.json` to `PROD\COMP\SDDC_MANAGER_VCF\lcm\productVersionCatalog\`

7.4 LCM Service Fails to Start (UnknownHostException)

Cause: The SDDC Manager appliance cannot resolve its own hostname.

Fix: Add the hostname to `/etc/hosts` (Section 5.1). The entry must map the appliance IP to the FQDN and short hostname.

7.5 Connection Refused on Port 7100

Cause: An internal SDDC Manager service is not running or has not fully started.

Fix:

```
systemctl restart commonsvcs lcm
# Wait 3-5 minutes

# Verify all ports are listening
ss -tlnp | grep -E "7100|7200|7300|7400|7500"
# All five ports should show LISTEN state
```

7.6 Certificate Already Exists (Alias Conflict)

Cause: The certificate was already imported with the same alias.

Fix: This is safe to ignore. If you need to replace the certificate:

```
keytool -delete -alias offline-depot -keystore $CACERTS -storepass "changeit"
keytool -importcert -trustcacerts -alias offline-depot -file /tmp/depot.crt \
  -keystore $CACERTS -storepass "changeit" -noprompt
```

7.7 ESXi Certificate SAN Mismatch (SSLPeerUnverifiedException)

Cause: ESXi hosts were booted before their hostname was configured. The auto-generated SSL certificate contains `localhost.localdomain` as the SAN instead of the actual FQDN.

Symptoms:

```
javax.net.ssl.SSLPeerUnverifiedException: Certificate for <esxi01.lab.local>
doesn't match any of the subject alternative names: [localhost.localdomain]
```

Fix: On each ESXi host, regenerate the SSL certificate:

```
ssh root@esxi01.lab.local

# Verify hostname is correct
esxcli system hostname get

# If wrong, set it
esxcli system hostname set --fqdn=esxi01.lab.local

# Regenerate certificates
mv /etc/vmware/ssl/rui.crt /etc/vmware/ssl/rui.crt.bak
mv /etc/vmware/ssl/rui.key /etc/vmware/ssl/rui.key.bak
/sbin/generate-certificates

# Restart ALL management services (hostd-only restart is insufficient)
services.sh restart

# Verify new certificate SAN
openssl x509 -in /etc/vmware/ssl/rui.crt -noout -text | grep -A2 "Subject
Alternative"
```

Verify from SDDC Manager:

```
echo | openssl s_client -connect esxi01.lab.local:443 2>/dev/null | openssl x509 -
noout -text | grep -A2 "Subject Alternative"
```

Repeat for all ESXi hosts before proceeding with VCF deployment.

7.8 ESXi Host Connection Refused After Certificate Regeneration

Cause: `services.sh restart` did not fully bring all management services back up.

Fix: Access the ESXi host console (VMware Workstation console, press Alt+F1 for shell):

```
/etc/init.d/hostd start
services.sh restart
```

7.9 vSAN Storage Policy Non-Compliant During Bringup

Symptoms: Bringup stuck at "Enable vSAN Policies." The domainmanager log shows:

```
VM vcenter is not compliant with the default storage policy
Waiting for 60 secs before checking storage compliance again
```

Cause: vSAN is actively rebuilding/resyncing data. The default policy requires FTT=1, which can't be satisfied until resync completes. The bringup checks every 60 seconds and proceeds automatically.

How to verify it is NOT hung:

```
tail -f /var/log/vmware/vcf/domainmanager/domainmanager.log | grep -E
"compliant|Waiting|vsan"
# New lines every 60 seconds = working. Do NOT restart services.
```

How to check if it IS hung:

```
curl -s -k -u admin:<password> https://localhost/v1/sddcs | python3 -m json.tool |
grep -i "status"

# Check all services running
systemctl status commonsvcs domainmanager lcm operationsmanager | grep -E
"Active:|service"
```

```
# Verify all ports listening
ss -tlnp | grep -E "7100|7200|7300|7400|7500"
```

Resolution: Wait for vSAN resync to complete. In nested environments this can take 30-60+ minutes. Do NOT restart services.

7.10 VCF Operations Deployment Timeout (OVA Upload)

Symptoms: VCF Operations deployment fails with:

```
failed due to time out after 20 MINUTES with exit value 137
```

Cause: The ovftool OVA deployment has a hardcoded 20-minute timeout in the domainmanager JAR. In nested environments with slow disk I/O, the upload can't complete in time. No external configuration exists to change this timeout.

Fix: Manual OVA Deployment with ovftool

Step 1: Discover vCenter inventory path:

```
ovftool --noSSLVerify "vi://administrator%40vsphere.local:
<password>@vcenter.lab.local/"
# Lists datacenters — drill into each level:
ovftool --noSSLVerify "vi://administrator%40vsphere.local:
<password>@vcenter.lab.local/<datacenter>/host/"
```

Step 2: Find the OVA:

```
find /nfs/vmware/vcf/nfs-mount/bundle/ -name "Operations-Appliance*.ova"
2>/dev/null
```

Step 3: Deploy manually (single-line command — no backslash continuation):

```
ovftool --acceptAllEulas --skipManifestCheck --noSSLVerify --diskMode=thin --
powerOn --name=vrops-appliance --datastore=vcenter-cl01-ds-vsan01 --net:"Network
1"="vcenter-cl01-vds01-pg-vm-mgmt" --prop:vamitimezone=UTC --
prop:root_password='<password>' "/nfs/vmware/vcf/nfs-mount/bundle/<bundle-
```

```
id>/<bundle-id>/Operations-Appliance-9.0.1.0.24960351.ova"
"vi://administrator%40vsphere.local:<url-encoded-
password>@vcenter.lab.local/vcenter-dc01/host/vcenter-cl01/"
```

Important: *Special characters in the password must be URL-encoded in the vi:// URL (e.g.,* `!` *=* `%21` *). The* `@` *in* `administrator@vsphere.local` *must be encoded as* `%40` *. OVF network name "Network 1" must be mapped to the target portgroup using* `--net:` *syntax.*

7.11 vCenter Hostname Not Resolving from SDDC Manager

Symptoms: ovftool fails with `"No version for VMODL calls"` or curl to vCenter returns empty.

Fix: Add vCenter to `/etc/hosts` :

```
echo "192.168.1.69 vcenter.lab.local vcenter" >> /etc/hosts
python3 -c "import socket; s=socket.socket(); s.settimeout(5);
s.connect(('vcenter.lab.local',443)); print('OPEN'); s.close()"
# Expected: OPEN
```

If vCenter services are down:

```
ssh root@vcenter.lab.local
service-control --status
service-control --start --all
```

7.12 Nested ESXi: Promiscuous Mode and Forged Transmits

Symptoms: Network failures between nested VMs, vMotion failures, or vSAN connectivity issues.

Cause: Nested ESXi VMs generate traffic with MAC addresses different from the parent VM's NIC.

Fix: Enable these security settings on ALL VDS portgroups (Management, vMotion, vSAN, VM-Mgmt):

- Promiscuous Mode: **Accept**
- Forged Transmits: **Accept**
- MAC Address Changes: **Accept**

7.13 Monitoring Depot Server Requests

The HTTPS server logs all requests to the console:

Code	Meaning
`200`	Successful request
`404`	Missing file — check path and filename
`401`	Authentication failure (auth-enabled server only)

---

8. Key File Locations

8.1 Windows Depot Server

File	Path
FIPS HTTPS Server	`C:\VCF-Depot\https_server_fips.py`
Auth HTTPS Server	`C:\VCF-Depot\https_server.py`
TLS Certificate	`C:\VCF-Depot\server.crt`
TLS Private Key	`C:\VCF-Depot\server.key`
Depot Root	`C:\VCF-Depot\PROD\`
Startup Script	`C:\VCF-Depot\start_depot.bat`

8.2 SDDC Manager / VCF Installer Appliance

File	Path
Java cacerts	`/usr/lib/jvm/openjdk-java17-headless.x86_64/lib/security/cacerts`
Commonsvcs Trust Store	`/etc/vmware/vcf/commonsvcs/temp_java_trusted_certificates.store`
Hosts File	`/etc/hosts`
Commonsvcs Logs	`/var/log/vmware/vcf/commonsvcs/`
Domain Manager Logs	`/var/log/vmware/vcf/domainmanager/`
LCM Logs	`/var/log/vmware/vcf/lcm/`
OVFTool Logs	`/var/log/vmware/vcf/domainmanager/vcf-ops-ovf-tool-*.log`

Bundle Downloads	`/nfs/vmware/vcf/nfs-mount/bundle/`

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9. Quick Reference: Complete Setup Sequence

1. Generate TLS certificate on Windows depot server
2. Extract metadata zip into `PROD\` directory structure
3. Place all component binaries in `PROD\COMP\<COMPONENT>\` directories
4. Start the HTTPS depot server on port 8443
5. Open Windows Firewall port 8443
6. SSH into SDDC Manager / VCF Installer
7. Fix `/etc/hosts` — add appliance hostname and vCenter hostname
8. Extract depot certificate using `openssl s_client`
9. Import certificate into Java cacerts
10. Import certificate into commonsvcs trust store (if exists)
11. Restart `commonsvcs` and `lcm` services
12. Wait 2-3 minutes for services to initialize
13. Configure depot in SDDC Manager UI (IP, port 8443, path `/PROD`)
14. Download binaries
15. If VCF Operations OVA deployment times out, use manual ovftool deployment (Section 7.10)

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10. References

- Broadcom KB 312168 — VCF Offline Depot Deployment
- Broadcom KB 413848 — Path Not Found Error
- Broadcom Techdocs — Set Up an Offline Depot Web Server
- Broadcom Techdocs — Download Install Binaries to an Offline Depot
- William Lam — VCF Software Depot Structure Deep Dive

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This handbook is intended for lab and educational purposes. Always consult official VMware documentation for production deployments.

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